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Install OpenClaw on Windows (WSL2 + Docker Desktop)

Prerequisites

- Windows 10/11
- Administrator access on Windows
- Internet access

Part 1 — Install WSL2 + Docker Desktop (one-time setup)

1) Enable WSL2

(Windows / PowerShell as Administrator)

```
wsl --install
```

Restart the PC when prompted.

2) Install Docker Desktop

1. Install Docker Desktop
2. Open Docker Desktop → **Settings**:
 - **General** → enable **Use WSL 2 based engine**
 - **Resources** → **WSL Integration** → enable your Ubuntu distro

3) Quick test (WSL2)

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
docker version  
docker compose version
```

If you see both **Client** and **Server**, you're good to go.

Part 2 — Download and start OpenClaw

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
cd ~  
git clone https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw  
cd openclaw  
./docker-setup.sh  
docker compose up -d  
docker compose ps
```

You should see the **gateway** as “Up” and ports **18789–18790**.

Part 3 — Open the Dashboard

Start services

```
docker compose up -d
```

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

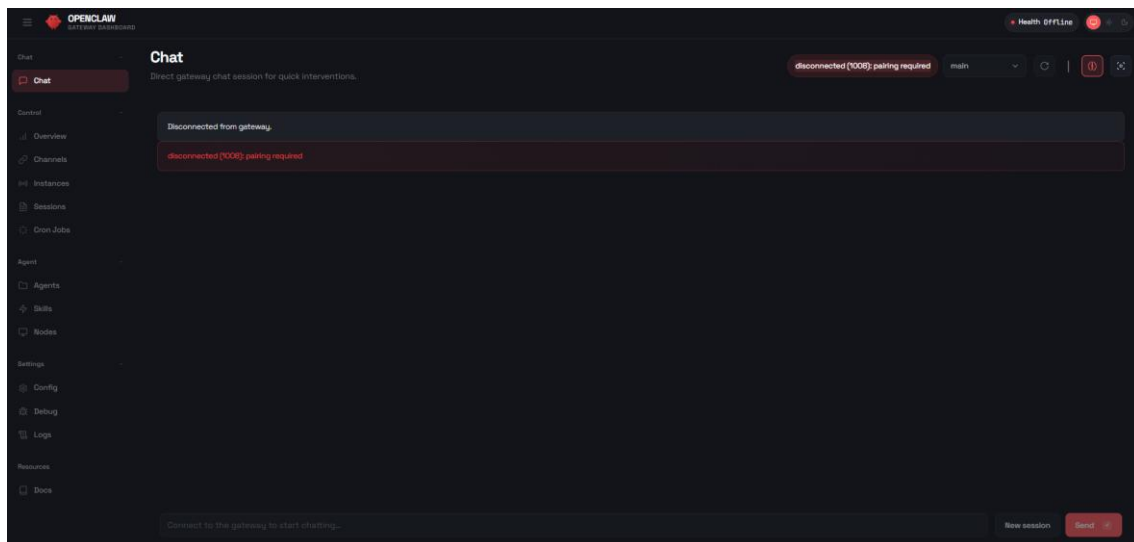
```
docker compose run --rm openclaw-cli dashboard --no-open
```

(Windows browser)

Open the dashboard link (usually <http://localhost:18789>).

Fix a Common Docker Error

 **disconnected (1008): pairing required**



This happens because of Docker Desktop's internal network/NAT when using WSL2.

✓ The fix is to force **token authentication** in the gateway.

Step A) Find the gateway container

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
docker ps --format "table {{.Names}}\t{{.Ports}}"
```

Note the name (example: openclaw-openclaw-gateway-1).

Step B) Enter the container

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
docker exec -it openclaw-openclaw-gateway-1 /bin/bash
If /bin/bash doesn't exist:
docker exec -it openclaw-openclaw-gateway-1 /bin/sh
```

Step C) Create the config file (token + proxies)

(Inside the container)

1. Create folder:

```
mkdir -p /home/node/.openclaw
```

2. Create config (replace the token with your own):

```
cat > /home/node/.openclaw/openclaw.json << 'EOF'
{
  "gateway": {
    "mode": "local",
    "bind": "lan",
    "port": 18789,
    "controlUi": {
      "enabled": true,
      "allowInsecureAuth": true
    },
    "auth": {
      "mode": "token",
      "token": "1542658497515794168875165986594"
    },
    "trustedProxies": ["192.168.65.0/24", "172.17.0.0/16"]
  }
}
EOF
```

3. Verify:

```
cat /home/node/.openclaw/openclaw.json
```

Step D) Exit and restart

(Inside the container)

exit

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
docker restart openclaw-openclaw-gateway-1
```

Step E) Open the dashboard with token

(Windows browser)

```
http://localhost:18789/?token=PUT_A_STRONG_TOKEN_HERE
```

It should open normally.

Quick diagnostics (if it still doesn't open)

(Ubuntu / WSL2)

```
docker logs openclaw-openclaw-gateway-1 --tail 120
```

Extra (optional): save the link

After it works, bookmark:

```
http://localhost:18789/?token=YOUR_TOKEN
```

Fix reference:

```
https://github.com/openclaw/openclaw/issues/6959
```